EJ FOX



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PROFILE

Design engineer and creative technologist who ships under pressure. I transform complex information into clear interactive visuals and have fun doing it. My work combines journalistic curiosity with an addiction to trying new things—from NBC's election graphics to experimental embedding interfaces. I want to make things no one has seen before with smart, kind people.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Code: JavaScript, Python, Node.js, Vue, React, TypeScript, HTML/CSS, SQL

Graphics: D3, Observable Plot, Three.js, WebGL, Canvas, SVG, TopoJSON

AI/ML: LLM APIs, embedding visualization, context management, vector databases, prompt engineering, tool usage, alternative interfaces

Design & Motion: Illustrator, Photoshop, Final Cut Pro, After Effects, Principle, Figma, Animation (GSAP, Anime.js)

Methods: Rapid prototyping, joy-driven development, component systems, public documentation, performance optimization, video demos

EXPERIENCE

Lenfest AI Fellow

Arizona State University NEWSWELL | 2025 - 2026

The Lenfest Institute's AI Collaborative and Fellowship Program, hosted at ASU and supported by OpenAI and Microsoft

- I built a tool that uses AI to lay out the ads and stories in small local print newspapers
- I gave an Ignite talk about it at ASU's National Journalism + AI Accelerator in January 2026

Design Engineer & Creative Technologist

Independent Consultant | 2019 - Present

Select Clients: GitHub • NBC News • CBS News • Washington Post • New York Times • Carnegie Mellon • Stamen

- I take the tight-deadline projects that need short sprints and real user testing, especially things no one has built before
- I helped CBS News prototype its broadcast touchscreen app, analyzed newspaper front pages for the New York Times, and made geographic visualizations with the geniuses at Stamen.
- I work between design and engineering, in whatever stack the client already has, from brand-new startups to big companies with their own process
- I work in public when I can. There are 50+ Observable notebooks, plus livestreams on YouTube and blog posts about what I'm making and how.

Founder

Room 302 Studio | 2023 - Present

Select Clients: The Associated Press • Wildlife Conservation Society • Earth Genome

- My prototyping shop for new kinds of data visualization and analysis, usually on tight deadlines
- I built the studio's manager on top of an LLM. It's our 'AI team member'
- We turn rough ideas into demos good enough for a client to show their bosses or take to a funder

- I worked with the Associated Press team on its 2024 election coverage, which was nominated for a Webby.
- I helped the Wildlife Conservation Society map coral reefs that are holding up against climate change and tell their story

Contractor

Stamen Design | 2020 - 2022

- I made geographic visualizations with the Stamen team

Senior Interactive Graphics Specialist

NBC News | 2016 - 2019

- I was lead designer on the 2018 relaunch of the election-night Big Board and built it with Michael Small and the NBC News Digital teams. The New York Times called it "newly juiced-up." It's still in use today.

Graphics Editor

Vocativ | 2014 - 2016

- I automated enough of the desk to go from five graphics a month to five a day
- I led the winning Knight Foundation grant pitch for Dataproofer, a tool that checks datasets for errors
- I gave reporters a visualization platform they could use on their own, made the templates, and ran daily breaking-news graphics

Early Career

- *GitHub (2013)*: I worked with the GitHub team on the "State of the Octoverse" site and its visualizations
- *Visual.ly (2011)*: I was on the core team that built one of the first visualization-as-a-service platforms

PROJECTS

Subway Builder · Borough Studio, 2025 - 2026. Colin Miller's subway-building game. He was in Room 302 Studio and brought me on as his first developer. One of the lead developers. I built the desktop version for the July 2026 Steam launch.

Decision Desk HQ, 2025 - 2026. I work on design and engineering for the tools broadcasters use to show election results

Global Energy Ownership Tracker · Global Energy Monitor, 2025 - 2026. An explorer of who owns the world's energy assets, with ownership trees, embeddable cards and a screener

Paramilitary Leaks, 2025. I built an explorer and visualizations for 200 GB of leaked militia chats. Micah Lee cited it in his reporting.

NYPD misconduct network · WNYC/Gothamist, 2021. I did the network analysis of civilian complaint records for an investigation into clusters of officers accused of misconduct again and again

Climate TRACE · Earthrise Media, 2022. I made maps and data exploration tools for emissions sources around the world

Ukraine grain · Earth Genome, 2022 - 2023. A scrolling data story about global food security

COVIDcast · Carnegie Mellon University Delphi, 2020. I prototyped visualizations for the public COVID-19 indicators, July to September 2020

Election simulator · Washington Post Opinions, 2019 - 2020. I did engineering on an interactive simulator built on David Byler's election model

Dark-money map · Mother Jones, 2012. I co-authored an interactive map of the super PAC and dark-money universe